

EDUCATION

University of Washington · Exp June 2027
Ph.D. Human-Centered Design and Engineering
Concentration: Human-Computer Interaction
Seattle, WA

University of Washington · 2025
M.S. Human-Centered Design and Engineering
Seattle, WA

University of Virginia · 2022
M.S. Systems Engineering
Charlottesville, VA

Virginia Tech · 2018
B.S. Mechanical Engineering
Minor: Green Engineering
Blacksburg, VA

RESEARCH SKILLS

Interviews and Survey Methods

Interviews
Focus Groups
Survey Design
Thematic Analysis
Affinity Mapping

Experimental & Behavioral Methods

Within-Subjects & Between-Subjects Experimental Design
Remote Moderated Usability Testing
Heuristic Evaluation
Stakeholder Walkthrough

Participatory & Co-Design Methods

Participatory Design / Co-Design Facilitation
User Persona Development
Journey Mapping

PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Multi-Phase Study Design and Execution
Cross-Institutional Research Collaboration
Research Budget Management
Research Timeline and Milestone Management
Stakeholder Communication and Research Translation

SOFTWARE SKILLS & PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

Minitab
Tableau
Power BI
Qualtrics
Airtable
R/RStudio
LaTeX

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

DIS 2026 — Basoah, J., Reinecke, K., Rosner, D., & Ogbonnaya-Ogburu, I. F. Hopeful Failure: How Collaborative Design Fiction Reimagines AI.

CAC 2026 — Basoah, J., Scherer, W., Boyd-Sinkler, K., & Bailey, R. The SPORT-C Intervention: An Integration of Sports, Case-Based Pedagogy, and Systems Thinking Learning.

CSCW 2025 — Basoah, J. et al. Should AI Mimic People? Understanding AI-Supported Writing Technology Among Black Users.

AIES 2025 — Cunningham, J. L., Adjagbodiou, A., Basoah, J., et al. Toward Responsible ASR for African American English Speakers: A Scoping Review of Bias and Equity in Speech Technology.

FAccT 2025 — Basoah, J., Chechelnitsky, D., Long, T., et al. Not Like Us, Hunt: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs.

SELECTED INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

Design Researcher, Intern | Redmond, WA; June 2025 – September 2025

- Led foundational research shaping mid- to long-term AI UX strategy for Microsoft's Agent 365 initiative, focusing on risks and design opportunities around personified, agentic AI and AI-powered digital workers.
- Conducted an extensive literature and discourse review spanning over 30 academic research papers and public debate on agentic AI; synthesized insights into a taxonomy of 14 organizational, group, and individual-level risks.
- Mapped each risk to existing and emergent design mitigation tactics, producing a scalable risk-to-mitigation framework that informed BIC's Responsible AI design strategy.
- Conducted 15+ cross-functional interviews with engineers, product managers, and designers to understand perceptions and apprehensions toward agentic AI, uncovering needs for clearer design guardrails and risk literacy.
- Identified and prioritized the top three critical risks for immediate mitigation, collaborating with the cross-functional Agent 365 team to prototype design principle cards used to guide AI UX teams across BIC.
- Developed strategic recommendations and foresight and presented those findings to BIC's Corporate Vice President, research leadership, global design organization, and the company-wide Aether v-team, influencing the responsible deployment of agentic AI across Microsoft 365 and Dynamics ecosystems.
- Findings were surfaced by Microsoft's Office of Responsible AI and integrated into early company-wide policy and governance frameworks guiding AI agent design.

IBM Corporation

User Experience Researcher, Senior Intern | Remote; January 2024 – August 2024

- Initiated and implemented a company-wide program to identify challenges across multiple clients, with a focus on improving user experience and engagement.
- Conducted qualitative research through usability testing to guide design strategies for proprietary product development.
- Improved product's UMX score by 14% within a period of 6 months by identifying key areas for improvement and developing a strategic plan encompassing usability testing and design critiques with users to enhance user experience.
- Informed product team direction by conducting an in-depth qualitative study to identify and uncover new user segments for growth which influenced the design and development priorities of design iterations of user interfaces and product features.
- Through my qualitative research I was able to identify a new user group that the development team had not considered as primary users for the product. This led to the creation of a new user segment that influenced the direction taken with product enhancement.*

User Experience Researcher, Senior Intern | New York, NY; June 2023 – September 2023

- Analyzed over 20 customer feedback on a bi-weekly frequency to identify key highlights and challenges faced by customers during product beta testing program; analysis was used to influence product development and align with product strategy for the upcoming release.
- Compiled and synthesized over 100 user comments to inform the development of 5 generative research workshop sessions with user base; workshops served as the foundational discussions that shed light on user grievances with most recent product release
- Oversaw conduction of over 15 internal interviews to assess impact of 2 distinct visual frameworks on client adoption of the product platform, deriving 7 evidence-based insights and recommendations; findings served as foundation for exploratory research with customers that would garner greater adoption of product.

User Experience Researcher, Intern | Remote; May 2022 – December 2022

- Conducted 2 heuristic evaluations of IBM's z/OS Management Services Catalog product by evaluating primary end-to-end user flows of 2 personas with latest code; Identified 20 improvement points within user flows.
- Collaborated with User Experience Designer to architect and design team's 2 Airtable databases and sponsor user feedback forms; improvements allow for easy capture of user experience feedback and seamless integration with current client feedback process.
- Administered 6 usability tests on sponsor users with new product designs while working alongside the User Experience Designer to form a research plan; utilized an affinity map to synthesize results and then communicated to three-in-a-box team.
- Deployed an on-platform CSAT survey to 200+ users of IBM's z/OS Management Services Catalog, generating actionable customer satisfaction and usability data that fed directly into the team's product improvement roadmap.

SELECTED RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Tactile and Tactical Design Lab x Wildlab | University of Washington | Graduate Research Assistant

Not Like Us, Hunt: Measuring Perceptions and Behavioral Effects of Minoritized Anthropomorphic Cues in LLMs | Role: Lead Researcher | April 2024 – January 2025

- Designed and executed two large-scale user studies (n=985) examining whether LLM sociolect usage affects user reliance and perception among African American English (AAE) and Queer slang speakers.
- Recruited and coordinated 498 AAE speakers and 487 Queer slang speakers across counterbalanced question-answering tasks comparing LLM agents in Standard American English (SAE) vs. self-identified sociolect conditions.
- Found that both AAE and Queer slang speakers relied more on and held more positive perceptions of the SAE agent, while Queer slang speakers uniquely reported greater social presence from the sociolect agent, surfacing meaningful divergence across minoritized communities.
- Demonstrated the need to measure behavioral outcomes rather than assuming personalization leads to improved reliance and safety, challenging a dominant assumption in adaptive AI design.

Published in Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '25); 26.8% acceptance rate.

Should AI Mimic People? Understanding AI-Supported Writing Technology Among Black Users | Role: Lead Researcher | January 2023 – October 2023

- Designed and conducted a two-phase qualitative study examining how Black American users experience AI-supported writing technologies, combining 13 semi-structured interviews with a remote-moderated user study of Google Docs and ChatGPT.
- Synthesized findings across participants to document expectations, apprehensions, and perceptions of NLP tools among Black American users, contributing empirical grounding to an underexamined population in HCI research.
- Uncovered a novel concern absent from prior literature: the potential for AI-driven gradual erasure of Black American cultural expression as future generations increasingly depend on AI for information.

Published in Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW 2025); journal-style peer review with an effective selectivity of ~15–20%; received DEI recognition